

Site Evaluation Report

The following report outlines the findings from a site evaluation conducted for the establishment of tutoring centers in Romeoville, Chicago, and Aurora, Illinois. Space utilization, existing infrastructure, and the specific needs of students, tutors, and administrative staff were assessed during the site evaluation. At that time, insight into operational requirements, network setup, and technology expectations were discussed.

Existing Infrastructure:

Each location is:

- Able to handle non-cash payments
- Can have 10-20 employees working at one time with 2-3 printers at each location
- Fiber internet connection at location one and two but only cable at location three

Requirements for all locations:

- VPN between locations with the ability to remote into two locations directly
- Locations must share the database, documents, and applications
- Locations must have Windows 11 enterprise client
- All locations will also need video cameras in hallways and server rooms, with wide-angle being preferable in open areas and reception

Location 1 (Romeoville, IL):

- Staff network: Administrative staff only access to internal systems/resources
- Tutor/faculty network: Separate educator access to educational materials/resources
- Guest network: Internet access provided to students and visitors without access to internal systems
- DMZ web server: Host to public-facing applications, like any websites or activities, while still isolated from the internal network
- Storage server: Centralized area for shared files, while ensuring that data is available and has safe backups

Location 2 (Chicago, IL):

- Staff network: Administrative staff only access to internal systems/resources
- Tutor/faculty network: Separate educator access to educational materials/resources
- Guest network: Internet access provided to students and visitors without access to internal systems

Location 3 (Aurora, IL):

- Staff network: Administrative staff only access to internal systems/resources
- Tutor/faculty network: Separate educator access to educational materials/resources
- Guest network: Internet access provided to students and visitors without access to internal systems

The Romeoville location will serve as the main center spanning 3,600 square feet. This location will have a reception area (400 sq ft), a large office (200 sq ft), 10 private offices (each 150 sq ft), an open plan designed to accommodate 20 students or tutors (1200 sq ft area), and server room (400 sq ft). There will be 4 phones at this location, with reception and the large office having a phone each, as well as two of the ten private offices will have a phone. The tutoring center will have both a drop floor and a drop ceiling.

The Chicago location occupies 3,000 square feet. This location will have a reception area (400 sq ft), 11 private offices (150 sq ft each) with 8 being usable, an open plan workstation area for 10 students or tutors (600 sq ft total), a server room (150 sq ft), and 2 closets (100 sq ft each). There will be 4 phones at this location, with reception and two of the eleven private offices having a phone, as well as the workstation area having a phone. This location will also have a drop ceiling.

The Aurora location at 3,000 square feet. This location will have a reception area (400 sq ft), 7 usable private offices (150 sq ft), an open-plan workstation area for 20 students or tutors (1200 sq ft), a server room (200 sq ft), and one closet (150 sq ft). There will be 4 phones at this location, with reception and two of the seven private offices having a phone, as well as the workstation area having a phone. This location will also have a drop floor.

An analysis of user requirements was conducted to determine the essential technological and infrastructural support necessary for efficient operation of the tutoring centers. Tutors and faculty require private offices with reliable network access, printing capabilities, and VPN connectivity for secure remote access. The students require open workstation areas equipped with high-speed internet and tutoring software to facilitate learning. Additionally, administrative staff need a fully operational reception desk with dedicated phone lines, security cameras for monitoring, and the capability to process non-cash payments efficiently.

To maintain a secure and compliant operational environment, several security measures must be implemented across all three locations. A VPN setup is required to enable secure remote access for tutors, faculty, and administrative staff to ensure the protection of sensitive information. The shared database and document storage must comply with relevant privacy laws to protect student and faculty data. Surveillance systems should be installed at key locations, including hallways, server rooms, reception areas, and open workspaces. These

measures will be taken in compliance with legal requirements to ensure security while respecting privacy considerations.

Budget will include:

- DMZ server
- Storage server
- Phones
- Cameras
- Headsets
- Firewalls
- Windows 11 software
- VPN
- Networking equipment

The initial budget for setting up the tutoring centers is set at \$60,000, covering essential IT infrastructure, security systems, and office setup. This includes procurement of critical hardware such as servers, routers, switches, firewalls, phones, and workstations. Security-related expenses will account for the installation of cameras, access control systems, and VPN setup. Additionally, software licensing costs, including Windows 11 Enterprise, VPN, and tutoring management software, will need to be covered within this budget.

An additional budget of \$20,000 has been proposed to enhance infrastructure, security, and scalability. These additional funds could be allocated toward high-performance servers and backup storage solutions to ensure data integrity and business continuity. Advanced security measures, including high-resolution surveillance cameras and biometric access controls, could

also be implemented. Furthermore, improvements in network infrastructure, such as allocating funds to upgrade the Aurora location to fiber internet and deploying redundant backup solutions to strengthen connectivity and reliability.

Combining in-person and online tutoring sessions would provide greater flexibility to students, requiring VPN across all locations to ensure secure remote access for faculty and administrative personnel. Structured cabling and Wi-Fi distribution plans will be considered to optimize network connectivity. Additionally, a comparison of firewall solutions is being conducted to identify the most effective approach to data protection. Legal considerations regarding student data privacy are also being reviewed to ensure full regulatory compliance.

The site evaluation for the proposed tutoring centers in Romeoville, Chicago, and Aurora has provided valuable insights into infrastructure needs, user requirements, and budget considerations. Each location presents unique challenges and opportunities, requiring strategic planning and investment to establish an efficient learning environment. The next phase of planning and implementation will focus on connectivity, operational efficiency, and long-term sustainability.

We evenly contributed to this analysis.